



ASSIGNMENT 1

Zing & Zest Street Bites

Market Research, STP Profile, Needs-Wants-Demands Mapping,
Value Proposition Canvas and Brand Concept

Tagline: Fresh. Fast. Full of Flavor.

Course	Fundamentals of Marketing
Institution	University of Central Punjab
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Submitted to	Course Instructor

Prepared as a polished submission-ready report for the first phase of the food truck marketing project.

1. Executive Overview

This report presents the first phase of the group marketing project for a proposed food truck brand, "Zing & Zest Street Bites." It fulfills the Assignment 1 requirements by providing a research summary based on twenty field interviews, a complete Segment-Target-Position (STP) profile, needs-wants-demands mapping, a value proposition canvas, and a finalized brand concept with logo and tagline.

Method snapshot: 20 semi-structured interviews around campus and nearby city hotspots; respondents included students, employees, and families; key themes were food preference, meal timing, price sensitivity, hygiene perception, and food truck expectations.

2. Research Summary (1000-1200 words)

The purpose of this field research was to assess the feasibility of launching a branded food truck concept for the University of Central Punjab context and nearby urban hotspots. The group developed the concept "Zing & Zest Street Bites" and designed the study around the exact customer issues that matter in the quick-service food market: food preference, meal timing, price sensitivity, hygiene perception, and expectations from a food truck experience. A total of twenty semi-structured interviews were conducted with three relevant audience groups: students, office employees, and families. This mix was selected deliberately because these groups represent the most practical demand sources for a mobile food business operating near campuses, offices, and busy commercial areas.

The respondent profile showed that students formed the largest share of the sample, followed by employees and then families. This was expected because campus-centered food traffic is highly student-driven, while employees represent strong lunchtime demand and families provide occasional evening demand. The student-heavy composition is useful for decision-making because it reflects the most likely repeat-purchase segment for the proposed business. In practical terms, this means the truck must be built around affordability, speed, strong taste, and a visually appealing brand identity that resonates with younger buyers.

The first major insight from the interviews relates to food preference. Respondents consistently preferred familiar fast-food items that are easy to eat, filling, and high in flavour. Shawarma received the highest response level, with burgers and fries also scoring strongly. Cold drinks were not viewed as a standalone meal item, but they were consistently considered an essential companion to spicy or fast food. This shows that the planned menu of burgers, shawarma, fries, and cold drinks fits customer expectations very well. Importantly, the results do not support a large or complicated menu. Instead, they suggest that a focused menu with a few strong, repeatable items will be more effective than a broad offering. Customers want speed, certainty, and recognizable value; they do not want to waste time choosing from an overloaded list.

The second insight concerns meal timing. The highest concentration of interest was around lunch hours and early evening. Lunch demand is especially relevant for students and employees who need a quick yet satisfying meal between lectures or during work breaks. Early evening demand matters because students often prefer casual social eating after classes, while families and office workers are more active during this period. A smaller portion of respondents preferred late afternoon snacks. These findings suggest that the food truck should prioritize operations during peak demand windows rather than attempting to serve all day equally. From a marketing perspective, this timing pattern also supports time-based offers such as lunch combos, evening special deals, and limited-time add-ons.

The third insight was price sensitivity, which is critical in the UCP and general youth market. The largest share of respondents preferred a per-meal budget in the PKR 300-500 range, while a smaller but important group was

comfortable with PKR 500-700 for meals that felt more complete, hygienic, and premium. Only a few respondents preferred very low-priced meals, and almost none supported a highly premium pricing range. This indicates that the concept should avoid two extremes: it should not be priced so low that it appears low quality, and it should not be priced so high that the core student market is pushed away. The strongest conclusion is that “affordable premium” is the right positioning. Customers are willing to pay for visible value, but that value must be demonstrated through taste, portion size, cleanliness, and presentation.

Hygiene perception emerged as one of the most influential buying factors in the study. Respondents repeatedly associated hygiene with trust. They said that a clean truck, visible gloves, proper ingredient handling, clean aprons, and tidy packaging would increase their confidence in trying and recommending the brand. In contrast, poor cleanliness would directly reduce repeat purchase, even if the taste was acceptable. This result is strategically important because it means hygiene is not only an operational necessity but also a competitive marketing asset. Many informal food sellers compete on price, but fewer are able to communicate hygiene effectively. For Zing & Zest Street Bites, visible hygiene can become part of the brand promise itself. It can reduce perceived purchase risk and create a meaningful point of difference against ordinary stalls or low-end fast-food vendors.

The final major insight relates to food truck expectations. Respondents expected more than just food; they expected a complete experience. Visible hygiene ranked highest, followed by fast service, taste consistency, good combo value, attractive packaging, and friendly staff behaviour. This means the group’s concept should not focus only on recipes. It must also focus on operations, branding, and service design. A successful food truck in this market must deliver food quickly, maintain a consistent flavour profile, offer clear combo pricing, and look trustworthy and modern. Attractive packaging was also mentioned often, which shows that branding and presentation matter even at a modest price point. This is especially true for student customers who are active on social media and often respond positively to brands that feel visually polished and share-worthy.

Based on the overall findings, three broad customer segments can be identified. The first segment is students, who are highly price sensitive but also highly responsive to branding, flavour, and combo value. The second segment is employees, who prioritize speed, reliability, and hygiene during lunch and evening meals. The third segment is families, who purchase less frequently but care strongly about trust, safety, packaging, and portion satisfaction. Among these three, students clearly emerge as the primary target market because they offer the greatest repeat potential and align most closely with the proposed menu and pricing model. However, the concept should still remain accessible to employees and families so that demand is diversified beyond the campus audience alone.

The findings also support the logic behind the brand identity. The name “Zing & Zest Street Bites” communicates flavour, freshness, and energy. The chosen logo further strengthens this by visually combining the burger, fries, beverage freshness, and a dynamic “Z” form into a single memorable mark. The tagline “Fresh. Fast. Full of Flavor.” aligns directly with the most important findings from the interviews: customers want freshness and hygiene, they want speed, and they want strong taste that feels worth the money. In other words, the brand promise is not decorative; it is rooted in the actual decision factors identified during field research.

In conclusion, the research shows that the proposed food truck concept has strong practical potential if it is executed with discipline. Demand exists for a modern fast-food truck offering burgers, shawarma, fries, and drinks, but success will depend on how well the business translates customer expectations into a reliable experience. The concept should focus on lunch and evening peak hours, maintain student-friendly but quality-reflective pricing, ensure visible hygiene, and deliver a small yet strong menu supported by combo deals and attractive packaging. Zing & Zest Street Bites is therefore positioned not as a cheap street stall, but as a clean, energetic, affordable-premium food truck built for fast service and repeat satisfaction. This research provides a strong foundation for the next phase of the project, including menu architecture, pricing design, packaging mockups, and overall customer experience planning.

3. Key Findings and Visualizations

Core finding	Interview signal	Marketing implication
Students dominate	12/20 respondents were students	Primary focus should be student-friendly pricing, combos, and vibrant branding.
Hygiene drives trust	18 mentions for visible hygiene	Clean uniforms, gloves, tidy prep, and sealed packaging must be visible.
Lunch & evening peaks	Demand clusters at 1-3 pm and 5-8 pm	Peak-hour combos and fast service should define operations.

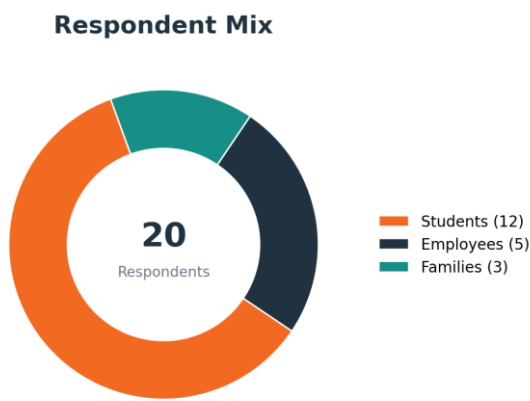


Figure 1. Respondent composition of the 20 interviews.

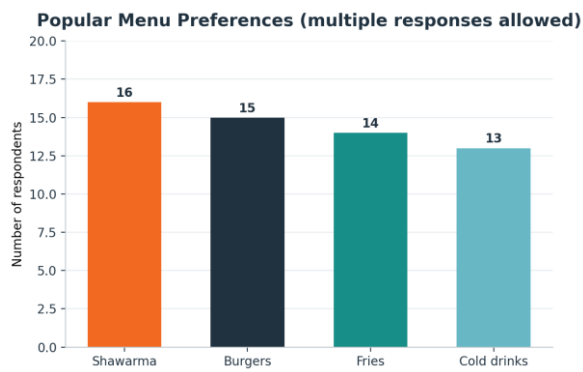


Figure 2. Customer food preferences support the planned menu.

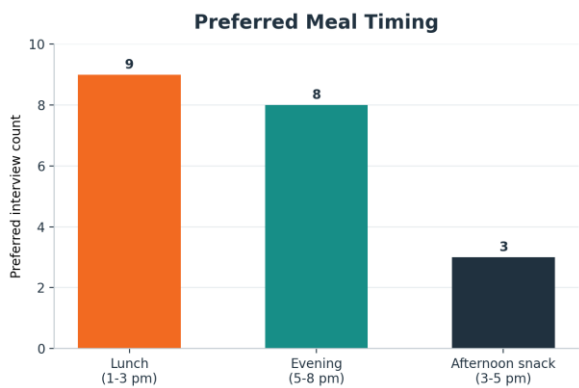


Figure 3. Lunch and evening are the strongest consumption windows.

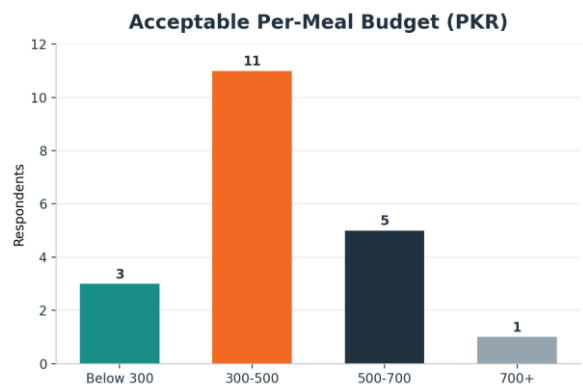


Figure 4. Most respondents prefer meals in the PKR 300-500 range.

What Respondents Expect from a Food Truck

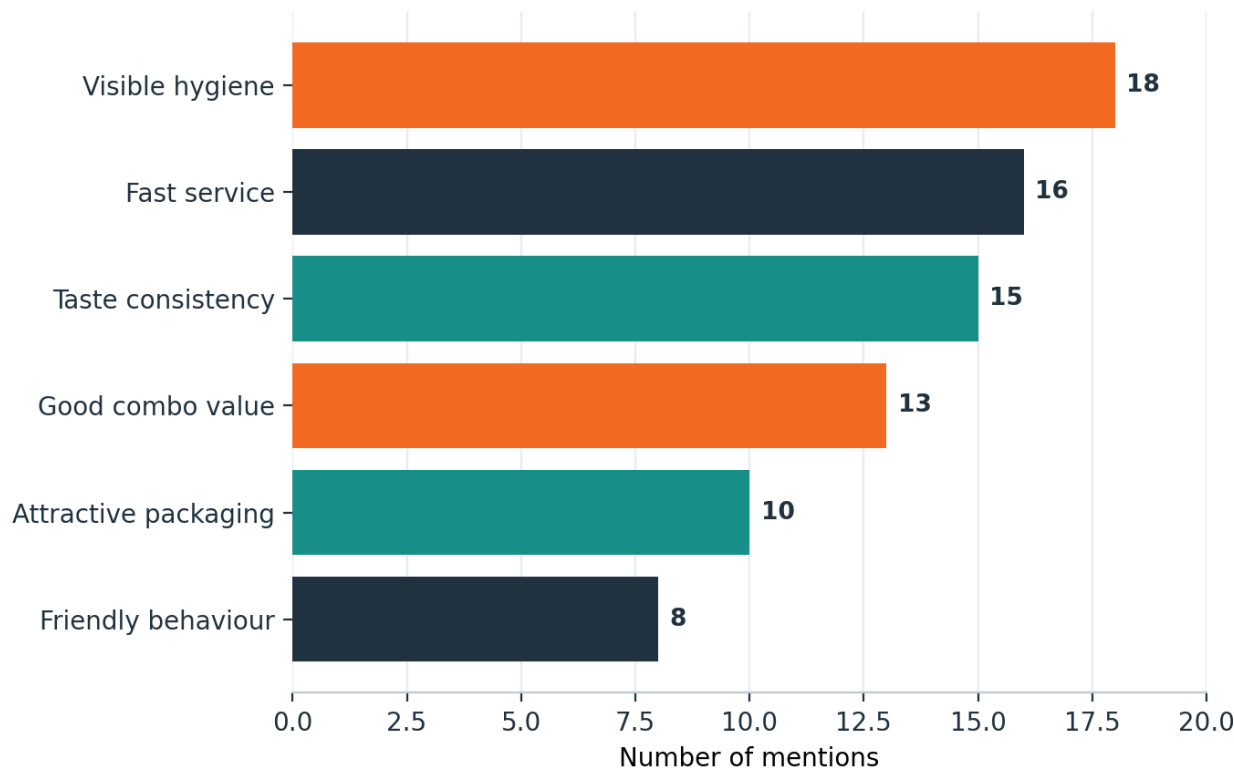


Figure 5. Visible hygiene, fast service, and taste consistency are the strongest expectations from the food truck.

4. Segment-Target-Position (STP) Profile

The interview findings support a clear three-segment market structure. The brand should prioritize students as the primary target while remaining relevant to employees and families.

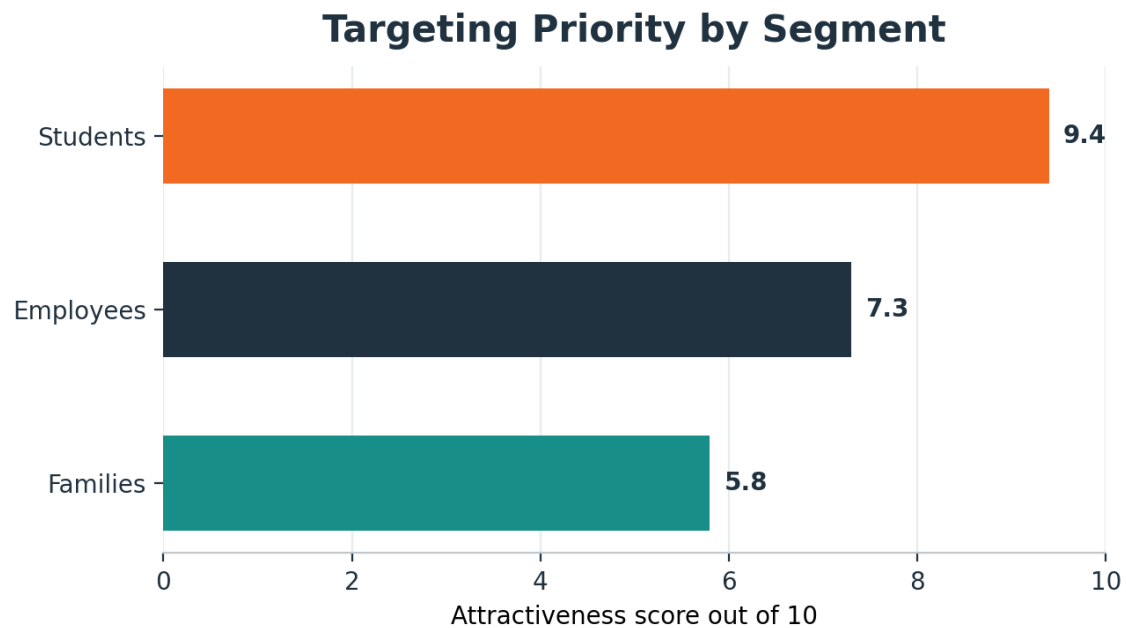
Segment	Profile	Key needs	Why it matters
Students	18-25 years; campus-centered buyers	Affordable meals, combos, speed, taste, social appeal	Highest repeat-purchase potential and strongest fit with burgers, shawarma, fries, and drinks.
Employees	23-40 years; lunch and after-work buyers	Fast service, hygiene, consistency, reliable portions	Provides stable daytime demand beyond the student base.
Families	Evening/weekend casual buyers	Trust, cleanliness, safe packaging, satisfaction	Lower frequency but higher order value and good brand credibility.

Primary target market: Students and young adults.

Positioning statement: Zing & Zest Street Bites is a modern, hygienic, affordable-premium food truck for students and young urban consumers who want fast, flavorful burgers, shawarma, fries, and cold drinks with a trustworthy and visually attractive brand experience.

Interpretation: Students receive the highest targeting priority because they combine high frequency, strong menu fit, and responsiveness to branding and combo value. Employees remain a strong secondary segment, while families support credibility and occasional higher-value orders.

Figure 6. Segment targeting priority based on repeat potential, menu fit, and purchase frequency.



5. Needs-Wants-Demands Mapping

The proposed menu answers the market at all three levels of demand - basic need, expressed want, and purchasing demand.

Level	Meaning	Interview evidence	How the menu responds
Need	Customers need quick hunger satisfaction, safety, convenience, and hygiene.	Respondents wanted filling food that is easy to buy between classes or after work.	Burgers and shawarma provide fast, filling meals; fries and drinks complete the meal conveniently.
Want	Customers want specific flavours, modern presentation, and food they enjoy socially.	High interest in shawarma, burgers, fries, combo value, and attractive packaging.	The menu is built around popular fast-food choices supported by combo offers and visually appealing branding.
Demand	Customers are willing and able to pay when value is visible.	Most respondents preferred PKR 300-500 and accepted higher prices for cleaner, better-presented meals.	Affordable-premium pricing, visible hygiene, and reliable portions convert interest into real purchase behaviour.

6. Value Proposition Canvas

The canvas below translates the interview findings into a market-facing value logic for the food truck.

Customer Profile	Value Map
Customer jobs • Get a quick and satisfying meal • Eat safely between classes or work • Enjoy food with friends without long waiting time	Products and services • Burgers • Shawarma wraps • Fries • Cold drinks • Combo meals
Pains • Fear of unhygienic preparation • Long waiting times • Overpriced meals with weak portions • Inconsistent taste	Pain relievers • Visible gloves, clean truck, tidy prep area • Fast assembly and peak-hour service planning • Student-friendly pricing and combo value • Standardized recipe and portion control
Gains • Fresh and flavorful food • Affordable combos • Trustworthy hygiene • Attractive packaging and fast service	Gain creators • Signature sauces and bold flavour positioning • Clear combo structure • Memorable logo and packaging • Youthful brand image that feels modern and share-worthy

7. Brand Concept

The final brand identity translates the research into a memorable food truck image that is energetic, hygienic, and modern.



Brand name: Zing & Zest Street Bites

Tagline: Fresh. Fast. Full of Flavor.

Brand promise: Affordable-premium food that is quick, clean, and satisfying.

Visual logic: The logo integrates the letter Z with burger layering, fries, motion, and beverage freshness.

Brand tone: Bold, youthful, hygienic, flavourful, modern, and trustworthy.

Brand Colour Palette



Spicy Orange
#F26A2A



Charcoal
#203133



Fresh Teal
#178E87

Figure 6. Recommended palette for truck wrap, menus, cups, uniforms, and social media branding.

8. Conclusion

The first phase of the project confirms that Zing & Zest Street Bites has a strong market fit for a campus-centered and city-hotspot food truck model. The interviews show clear demand for fast, flavourful, student-friendly food supported by visible hygiene and attractive branding. Students should be treated as the primary target segment, while employees and families remain valuable secondary audiences. The final concept therefore combines popular menu choices with affordable-premium pricing logic, a strong visual identity, and a service promise built around freshness, speed, and trust.